in Eastern Ladakh on 10 February, and then the ceasefire on 24 February. Very satisfying indeed.

Rebalancing to the Northern Front

India has always faced numerous challenges to its national security, both external and internal. The external challenges, particularly on land, arise due to the unsettled nature of our borders. Thus, India faces a two-front threat, in the West from Pakistan, and in the North and North-east, from China. The Army continuously keeps reviewing the situation and re-evaluates the threat perception. It is based on this evaluation that perspective plans are chalked out and operational plans implemented. While perspective plans are formulated by the Perspective Planning Directorate, implementation falls under the Directorate General of Military Operations (DGMO), with both taking inputs from the Directorate General of Military Intelligence (DGMI).

Right from the time of Independence in 1947, the primary threat has been Pakistan, and rightly so. India had already fought three full-scale wars with Pakistan (1947–48, 1965, 1971) and a local war in Kargil (1999). In 1984, Pakistan attempted a grab action in Siachen, Western Ladakh, which was thwarted by the timely induction of forces, braving all odds. From the early 1990s, the spectre of terrorism in J & K raised its head, necessitating the deployment of forces in the Counter Insurgency and Counter Terrorism (CI/CT) role. The requirement of manning the LC in J & K, as well as the AGPL (Siachen) in strength, increased the requirement of troops. These were live borders and trans-LC firing was commonplace. The threat was such that there was no question of letting your guard down in this 'No-War, No-Peace' scenario. The majority of the Indian Army, therefore, faced Westwards.

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